

2.2.30 Standards

Optical media are governed by standards that are referred to as “Books,” like The Orange Book, The White Book, The Blue Book, etc. The Red Book, the original standard, specifies the requirements for Audio CDs. The White Book specifies the requirements for Video CDs.

2.2.31 TAO

The Track-at-Once mode of writing stops the writing process after a track is written, and does not add a Table of Contents (contrast with DAO). This allows the user to add another track later on, but till the last track is added and the Table of Contents written, the contents already on the media cannot be accessed. TAO is not to be confused with multisession writing.

2.2.32 Tracks

Every optical media or disk consists of a single spiral path, starting from the inner side and moving out, in which data is stored. This is called a track. A track is also used to denote the data portion in a session.

2.2.33 UDF

Universal Data Format is a file system used by optical media. It offers significant improvements over the older ISO 9660 used in CDs. UDF is the default format used in DVDs.

2.2.34 Video data

The search for faster and more capacious optical storage media is fuelled by the need to distribute video of better quality. This was evident in the emergence of DVD and now in the development of BD and HD-DVD. High Definition (HD) video refers to a video stream that meets or exceeds the resolution of 1280 x 720 pixels. In contrast, DVD Video supports resolutions up to 720 X 576 pixels, and Video CD supports a maximum of 352 x 288 pixels. Non-HD video is also referred to as Standard Definition (SD) video.

MPEG1 is the compression format used in VCDs, while MPEG2 is used in DVDs. The next generation media support multiple com-